

11/14/15 Nov 14 2002
Wow! A long windy day! Daysails are very strenuous. Left Tutuila at 6 am, for the 55-mile haul to Koonan Islands. Saw some huge dolphins - 6' or more 6-8 feet long. Saw whales yesterday. All pretty sailing along N 215 west coast, but you can't really enjoy it, it's so cold, very little habitation along the coast line. We had some good sailing at times, over 7 knots to windward for a while. We are in a tiny, protected harbor, only a few local boats moored. Happy that we were able to sail the whole way, and average 5 knots.
Fri Nov 15

Peaceful night in South Cove. Off again in gray morning to Gull Harbor Moana - 10 miles sail to tip of peninsula. We ate on the dock now with the cold south wind blowing in the boat, not very comfortable. Brian is thrilled, I am not. Hope it pays off.

Mon Dec 29

Sailing again - it feels good! We spent 6 weeks in Gull Harbor, didn't like it too much. The hot showers & internet access was good, but we hated the public showers. I worked for Dave Mackay, doing a website and then spent 6 days piloting some motor yacht. No fun cruising boats in Gull Harbor, no kinks for Brian to play with. We spent an evening with the MacKays (Flying Cloud) over a week, Brian spent the night several times. Went into Auckland one night for dinner, saw all the Americas Cup boats at the Yacht Club. Rented DVD's watched a lot of movies, saw and Henry Potter & Lord of the Rings on the big screen, saw One & was done with work, we moved to Manuapa Bay where

Trever & Leslie (fisher) we met in Tongo, live with their 4 kids, Jacob, Julia, Jasmine, & Jeremy. (Carl, 70 Gulf View Dr.) They are a great family. We had Christmas dinner at their house, Jake & Julia spent a lot of time on our boat. They took up for the day to Anawhata Beach on the west side, just 30 minutes from Auckland. We had a wonderful day, took a long hike up a canyon to an old Maori dam where there was a ring set in the rock. We had to go bouldering, walking through shoulder-high grass, wading the stream, walking in the woods. The view from the sand dunes on the beach was spectacular. The sand was black, the surf was white. Now we are moving north, to find warmer weather perhaps? Tried to get to Great Barrier Island, but the wind turned NE, so now we are at Bon Accord harbor on Kawau. Lots of boats here.

Mon Dec 30 2002

Kawau was ugly and crowded, didn't care for it there. Left this morning with a brisk east wind, but of course, it didn't last. We are rolling along at a very slow pace. Otherwise it is a beautiful warm! sunny day. We will try to anchor at the entrance to Whangarei tonight.

Wed Jan 15 2003

We loved Urquhart Bay, spent 5 days there, hiking and windsurfing. Ocean Beach on the other side was beautiful and we hiked all Tower Broom Head. Had a nice New Year's Eve, made potato gnocchetti and drank wine. Then we went up to Whangarei for a week. Ugly nasty dirty there but we got a lot accomplished.

about the other wind, got an oil pressure gauge - finally!
Left Monday, came back to Whangamumu Bay. Today we sailed north
to Whangamumu. Very rocky! Buses & Thomas are scarce, I am
kind of poor too. But we had a nice sail and Whangamumu
harbour is very picturesque, surrounded by cliffs. The remains
of an old whaling station are here. No towns, no houses!

Sat Jan 18

More great hiking at Whangamumu - we are exhausted yesterday
after hiking to some caves with a sandy beach. There were birds
flying every morning, very nice. The water was clear. Now
we are at Omakivi Cove, no other boats here, a pretty strand of
pines trees behind a sandy beach. Great view to the west of
the Bay of Islands, boats moving around. We enjoyed a close up
view of Cape Brett as we rounded the point.

Tues May 13

3 1/2 months sitting in Opua! Thomas hurt himself
wind surfing at Wairopaka - the prettiest spot in the Bay
of Islands. You could actually see the bottom there. Was
having out in Opua so he could go to the doctor. Big storm
in his hip joint - only time could cure it. Then I got
another job doing web pages for Bob & Mease Savage, the
Bay of Islands Travel Information let work. But we are
finally on our way, to South Mimiwa Reef. Nice 15 ft Scaevola
beach, cut it so, cold! Good by New Zealand - it was
an interesting time.

Wed May 14

Last night was beautiful, full moon, light SE winds, the boat rocking along at 6 knots. But of course, I didn't last and now we are getting ready to tack, 3pm and the wind turned NE. Oh well we knew it wouldn't be easy. Thomas has been seasick all day so I have had to do the deck work. Well we just tacked and of course the wind turned back SE, so we tacked again. Forgot what a pain in the ass sailing is! Anyway, lost 24-hour run - 135 mi.

We had fun in Opua. Met Sharon. Stive on Poeti's Place again, I took a lot of long walks with her and got to know her. Saw Anfield again briefly. Atkinson showed up the last 2 weeks were there. Really enjoyed Capos - Rob, Sharmen, and their 3 boys Brian, Scott, and Chris. Of course Brian became a big huddler with them. I got into fixing laptop computers for the German/Bwiss sailors and was a lot better than I really cared to be. Leo on moonlight was there, took us to Whangarei once, Ralf on Yelo let us borrow his car several times. But Sharon was the most generous, always taking people along with her. Finally met George + Lorraine on - Silent Runner, who we had seen in Bora Bora. Sharon organized lots of potluck meals nights at the Opua Cruising Club which were big fun. That was our main entertainment while we were there. Got to surf the net every day at work and bought a digital camera and another laptop on eBay. Thomas worked on the boat, time passed, and I got colder.

June May 15 2003

At 10:00 a birdhouse night, had to put in reefs, set the Yankee jib. Now we're banging along, relatively comfortably, as long as we ride down! 30 knots of wind, close reaching, heaving just to windward of our course. Everyone is over their seasickness. 24-hour run - 113 miles. But the sun is shining, the squalls are through, it's just trade winds.

June May 16

Can't say this is comfortable but we are sailing in the right direction. Still making edging from the "burnt line" on top of a NE wind shift. Squally weather, 25-30 SE, making around 5 knots. We spent most of yesterday sleeping, not much else to do. Brian ended up on the floor last night after fighting with the food and losing. Charlotte is happy with just a reefed mizzen and Yankee - we are glad to have the 2nd forestay with the jibbing we had welded to the bow spar in Oahu. The sail is almost new and looks beautifully. Brian is a good sailor, he knows the boat, good, good, good, good, with cheer. 24-hour run - 125 miles.

June May 17

The wind keeps edging turning north - kind of frustrating. We can handle the discomf, the wetness, but to have to leave the well as a real hammer. Presently we are still logging along, just slowly on course. At least we got to Shaver and back our hour - 140 miles. Brian, who was not to wash until we reach Port! The roll is doing okay with starboard, double-reefed main and mizzen. The sun is not too good yet. 24-hour run - 138 miles.

Sun May 18

Wind turned NE last night, we are making very little easting now. Will need a favorable wind shift to get to South Minerva. Woke up to 30-35, very rough. Got the main down, been riding relatively comfortably with the boat closed up, no looking around today! We are all heading, nothing to do but keep still. Oh can't it jump!

24-hr run - 125 miles

Mon May 19

Ate only gotten worse - total cloud cover, squally all last night and today, but another reef in the mizzen. The boat is not slamming so much now. We are still heading due north, so will make Minerva Reef. Too bad - Capoz made it in this morning, we would like to be comfortably anchored! Instead we will have to continue on to Fiji. All the other boats are here too. It's not really that bad! Heavy weather is boring. I had to sew the bimini top - a seam had come undone. We got Brien to wash a little bit.

24-hr run - 100 miles

Tue May 20

The generally weather is finally through! The squalls were less violent and shorter last night and this morning we were able to set the yonkees. Passed South Minerva reef this morning, 35 miles to the west, and talked to Gene on Reflections. So we will carry on to Savu Savu. Heading due north, some sunshine today, I hardly any squalls. It was nice to talk to someone we know after being alone out here for a week. I took a nice rainwater shower this morning - it is much warmer. Back to shorts and T-shirts. It would have been nice to stop though, the boat is on an fuel nose.

24-hr run 110 miles

Wed May 21

Still specially, men up and men down, but the sun is out and we seem to be through the worst of the frost. Talked to Capag this morning, the boys were missing Brian. We wanted to stop so Ann, have time to clean up, get ready for Fiji, ok well. The boat is on shore late at night. But it is hot! We are doing normal in no shirt. Every towel on the boat is wet with sea water. And well get there on the weekend and have to hide from humans till Monday. Seem like I waste the same thing yesterday! Got an email from Sharon - Pet's Place - about how much the 30-hour flight back to Seattle was - little less she heard! 24 - he run 120 miles. Heard 20 knots, sea 3 meter swell, maintaining 5 knots to windward still - Charlotte can handle that!

Thurs May 22

Land ho! We spotted the first Fiji island a while ago. We will pass it by sunset, then sail between islands all night. Will arrive in Suva tomorrow sundown. A nice day, 15-20 minutes lots of sun, still going into it, but the big ocean swell is there - there are islands way to windward. We are happy with Charlotte - maintaining 5 knots to windward in big seas! 24-hour run - 135 miles.

Fri May 23

Good day! Thought we would have a nice calm sail last night, but wind and seas to the dawn, had full sails up. Caught a 4-ft moki maki! Went before sunset. Brian got it in with the new gaff - easier than

using a spear gun! So they ate well last night. I'm getting kind of tired of bread, cheese, and peanut butter! Then the wind died around 9 pm. We motored some port a long-lined fishing boat, but drifted most of the night. Wind came up this morning around 11, we have been sailing slowly but comfortably all day. I got to clean up and do some laundry! So we aren't anchored in Savusavu yet, no big deal, everyone is content on board. Been playing with the digital camera, doing email, been busy with the electronics organizer Thomas gave him. We got last week's email finally - the renters paid so life is good again! No hurry to get to harbor, it's weekend now. 0 24-hr run - 60 miles.

Sat May 24

It was a beautiful night - millions of stars, a nice 10 knot breeze, no ships in sight. We have enjoyed sailing in the Koro Sea. At sunrise we were 20 miles south of Savusavu. Took till 1 pm to get to anchor. It is incredible - reminds us of French Polynesia. White beaches, lots of swaying palm trees, lush green hills, clear blue water. And the water is warm! In the water is the place to be in Fiji, as the air is hot. Will take some getting used to. Everyone is happy with a good successful voyage completed. It's great to be cruising again!

Fri May 30

Left Cautian anchorage near Savusavu at 6 am - motor-sailing 40 miles to windward. It was not pleasant! Thought about turning around a few times, but once we got in the lee of Tavunani, the wind dropped. Met Cape and checked into Fiji

a big set of boobies! Today, hoping for light NE winds, we left at 4 am for Vanua Balavu, 50 miles to windward. Of course the wind went SE and picked up, we were basking again, just what we wanted to avoid. It was kind of miserable at times. But then we went into the lee of an island and managed to get some windward miles. Came in just an hour after Copoz! Its beautiful here, totally landlocked harbor, 6 other boats. Brian's birthday tomorrow - it's been a fun 12 years with him. We remember his birth and how perfect he was. Now he's almost as big as me, strong, well-muscled, a good-looking boy. Happy Birthday, buddy!

Monday June 23

It was a few 2 weeks out at Vanua Balavu. We stayed a week at the plantation. Went to the village to do Sewa-sewa, no big deal. The men went diving out on the reef several times, got lots of lobster. Got some soursop and coconuts from the locals. We had cake and movies for Brian's birthday. He got a Celtic necklace and some Game Boy games from Copoz. Did a bit of hiking but it was always muddy. Then we moved over to the Bay of Islands - very pretty - lots of little rocky islands but no where to go to shore. An island with Rick, Paddy and Jesse joined us for a few days and we had daily pot luck dinners. Took Copoz out to the reef on a couple of calm days and the reefs were fantastic out there. It was a nice place but we were missing Peaches, so today we are doing an overnighter to Draume ad Kan dreev. A bit too windy, just forward of the beam, not what we really wanted!

Tuesday June 27

At 8:00 up at sundown last night - up to 28 knots according to log. We had to reef down but Charlotte was flying - never 7 knots, must have been current. The seas were very confused. No sleeping - too many waves! Sailed into the Atoll - least 20 to 30 knots - about 9 pm. At 10:00 we were here - lots of keelers! The locals remember Cepas and are happy to see them. Q had a remora, try to attach to me when Q went swimming - yuck! We did 145 miles in 24 hours.

Wednesday July 8

So we have been 2 weeks in the Kodau - Atoll Lake Reef area. I'd organized a pig roast at Draumi last week that was great - 4 goats with kids. The extended family he knows there. The really enjoyed our time on Yakua - a deserted island with nice sandy beach. The kids built a big hut out of palm fronds with apart 2 nights sleeping ashore. We had beer for several nights. Met Billy Jones with Drew, Maurice and 11-year-old twins. Alice & Celeste and English make time with Jeff, Penny, and daughters Estel and Hayley, they are lots of fun! After Cepas arrived on, we moved to Buba and then to a bay on the south west corner of Kodau. Pretty big, very dramatic, but no where near all the grooves. At 10:00 and then for several days and have been stuck on the boat. Now we are at one, planning to go to Suva tomorrow.

Thursday July 9

Went a ride to Suva! We were on a good road - 30 knots - reefed down a reefed in 300, doing 7 knots. At 10:00. Got out but over 10 knots. Now we are in the big city spending money. Don't look that much better but the price of fuel & supplies are good!

Thurs July 15

Time to get out of Suva - we spent lots of money, got what we needed - new printer for \$50 US, a set of big wrenches for Thomas, new binoculars. We enjoyed the street food, loaded the boat with fruits & veg tables, saw Terminator III at the movie theater. Disappointment was not meeting any new people. Royal Suva Yacht Club was a bore. Got hit with more wind than we expected today, on a 30-mile sail out to Beqa. Wind kept picking up, under bare poles for a while! At least it is off the wind. Anchored in the harbor, feeling extremely wind blown, finally got the anchor to stick. It is very pretty here but there is no where else to go. Caught a big golden Dorado!

Thurs July 17

Out of that hole! We were leech over half the time at anchor, plus up to 50 knots, no fun at all. I did get in a swim yesterday, between rain squalls. Would have liked to visit the village, but it was too windy to launch the dinghy. It gusts 40 or more as we pulled up the anchor, motored the 4 miles out to the reef. Once on course downwind, with just a staysail, it is quite comfortable. Heading for Vanua Levu harbor, hoping for a calm anchorage for a change!

Fri July 18

Well it was a very comfortable night, totally calm, not much wind, what a change! Today the sun is hot, the wind is light. From the north, we are sailing with 2 other boats who were in Suva and spent the night with us. Just pattering along, enjoying the sunshine. Will stop in Natadola harbor, looks like it has a nice long beach.

Sat July 19 2003

What an awful night! We rolled overtop, no sleep. But we had a nice walk on the beach last night and Brian got to ride a horse. We met Othaca with Mike and Marguerita, who we had seen since Sierra. Today is great sailing, wind south of east, downwind along the SW coast of Uist here. We sailed on the reef entrance, flying at $6\frac{1}{2}$ knots. The west coast is much drier but also summer. Must come in not exactly a protected anchorage, rather open to the south, 50 ft deep, but holding seems to be good. Very beautiful, lots of white sand beaches, lots of wind, lots of boats!

Sat Aug 16

Four weeks in Nadi waters - it sure went fast! We had fun in Murelet Cove. Thomas had wild windsurfing for a week, Brian and I did some too, Brian hung out with the girls on Billy Bone, also met Saleka, English Master, Katherine, & 8-year-old Will aboard. Took a trip to Lautoka to go shopping and eat more cheap Qadian street food. Got some projects done on the boat. An ideal showed up just when we were ready to leave Fiji, had a couple of nice evenings with them. One more run to Lautoka to check on the couple of nights. Saw one Bay, then one last night at Murelet where the wind died. It was very pretty here, great salt-water pool with 25 meter deep lagoon, lots of walking, palm trees, white sand, blue water. The sun shone every day! But it's time to move on, light is under, to Vanuatu. We will have good

memories of Fiji - the stark coastal scenery, lush mangrove bays with deep green water, and the perfect tropical offshore islands. Challenging sailing - many cruises ended up on reefs. Today we motored past the reef, cut, then were becalmed. Motored until Q had had enough of it; then the wind came up right after Q sheeted it down! Sailing with lots of different sails - mizzen drifter, poled-out genoa, main + staysail.

Sun Aug 17

Nice night, although a bit chilly, had to do some sail changes in the middle of the night, mostly downwind but stealthy - running mizzen now with 4 sails up - yankee instead of staysail, mizzen drifter pulling well. 10-12 knots of easterly winds. Q got slow at times, but maintaining 4-5 knots. We passed a 40-ft cutter, almost keeping up with Silent Runner, George + Lorraine. All in all quite pleasant! Did catch a nice mahi this morning.

Tues Aug 18

Oops - messed yesterday! It wasn't much - Brian + Q started school, had a big fight over math, but the new science & social studies went well. Wind was very light from the east, then turned N.E., pushing the middle of the night. We were sailing beautifully to windward for a while, 5-6 knots in a flat calm sea. Then today we poled under a cloud line and the wind turned west, very light. We motored for several hours, now have to until something changes. Too bad - only 130 miles to go to Vila. Its not in our camp for table out here, no storms to fight. So we will sort here for now.

1st Aug 20
Happy birthday Thomas! 15 knots headwinds and we are ticking,
making into the sea and making very little progress. Charlotte
is not a particularly happy boat today. Otherwise the weather is
fine, nice sunny day. Lost two fish, one a nice maki. Guess well
be out here forever.

1st Aug 21
Well, we did about 40 miles yesterday, taking no stop. Got tired
in the morning, winds are lighter, can't hold a decent course, extremely
frustrated. Did catch a big bull dolphin this morning, one bright spot
in the day! Finally broke down and tried motoring but it's hopeless -
only 3.5 knots made good. Don't understand how all these other people
make motor for days on end. The wind is supposed to come up
tomorrow - we can only hope.

2nd Aug 22
The wind turned last night for 3 hours! We were so happy, the
boat was sailing so nice! At last finally came to the south this
morning and was sailed slowly, watching glaucous get bigger! Great
day, lots of sunbathing, we will be in just after dark tonight.
Everyone is happy, antipathy land fell. It was a long trip.

1st Sept 1

A quick week in Vila was usual. Anchored at 8pm near the quarantine
area. Perhaps was right on. Silent Runner didn't show up for two days -
then tomorrow had broken again and they have to, rather than
back. Guess we didn't do so bad after all. Lots of people have we
know - Roff with Danielle or Yelo and rest of all Don't know
with Mick, Hyman, Teddo, Eduardo & Greg. We hung out with them a
year ago in Tonga. That one was fun meeting with them.

also saw Amyr, Tranquility, Sayo, Qitono, Sojourner. Met a nice older Ausseer cabbie, Chris & Graham on Time Wise. Brian got quite friendly with Chris and I got Chap going on her XP laptop with USB interface. Thomas enjoyed eating cheap tender steak, we stopped for DVDs and duty free liquor. No other bargains here - food in the supermarkets costs twice as much as Fiji. We attended a local play showing the history of Vanuatu. Had a really good time in general, Brian was happy to see the Desert Rose kids again. But it's a pity, so Saturday, after we got our Australian visas (what a hassle - my last name Brian's new passport, they were confused by the situation but finally gave in as we had all important documentation) we moved, with Desert Rose and Time Wise to Melle Bay 5 miles away. There we decided with Fidelio & Aldebaran to do an overnighter to Epi. Don is usually good with the weather. He predicted a restful night, but that was not the case. We flew north in 20-25 knots SE on the beamy had to keep shortening sail to slow the boat down. Dawn found us 6 miles from Lamon Bay, and the wind died then turned NE. We were happy to get the boat down, not much rest last night. There is a desident dugong in the Bay and lots of loggerhead turtles.

Thurs Sept 4

Bunches of boats in Lamon Bay that we have met before - Fidelio, Time Wise, Arish Aldebaran, some others. We swam with the dugong and got to pet him and ride on him (kind of!) Had a birthday dinner with Time Wise. Thomas and Brian gave me some beautiful earrings made of red coral and mother of pearl. Thomas

was just recovering from a stomach bug, then Brian & I got it on Wednesday. It was awfully sick. What a 50th birthday - I will not forget it. Had to spend the day at anchor until we recovered. We are feeling better today. Right wind, so we set sail for the Macalline Islands off the coast of Malekula. Before we got there we had head winds! Pulled into a very nice snug little anchorage at Buvu Island, home of the magic weather stones - pieces of quartz that give off blue sparks when you strike them together, and cause thunderstorms. It is very calm and peaceful here, surrounded by mangroves, tiny sand beaches, shy natives paddling beautiful dugout canoes with proas. It is easy to hide old clothes for fruit.

Sept 6
Quiet day on Buvu anchorage yesterday. We launched the dinghy in the late afternoon and looked for the magic quartz rocks on the beach. We found a number of interesting, red & blueish quartz stones, some green stones, some white quartz. Had to order Brian and I strike them together! Left today originally for Embury, but the wind was really and it was a bit of a heat. After much deliberation, we set course for Oak Bay on Malekula, and down wind, Brian and I and both still feeling a bit under the weather. It was 20 knots along the coast. The volcano at Embury was spitting clouds of smoke and dust. Entered a nice little cove with a beautiful long sandy beach. All rest here for a day!

Mon Sept 8

Met some nice twins in Crab Bay - they actually came over to visit! Took a walk on the long sand beach, I saw a lion fish snorkeling in the shallows. I'm a bit nervous about swimming in Vanuatu - too many stories of tiger shark attacks! 40 miles to go today to Santo today and we are drifting in light winds, slowly heading north. It is peaceful out there at least! The air is very hazy, can hardly see any other islands.

Fri Sept 12

Just a few quick days in Luganville. Nice anchorage off the beach by the Beach Front Resort, nice Aussie folks running it. I finally saw a doctor and he said I have dengue fever. It explains my fatigue over the past month! Lucky I am almost over it just need to be careful, take it easy, not get bitten by a mosquito! Thomas scrubbed down the President Coolidge, an intact WWII wreck in 120 feet of water. He picked it, but it was very dark down there! Left town yesterday morning to do an overnight to Waterfall Bay. Vanua Lava, Banks Islands, where a festival is being held. Great sailing day, wind a bit light from the SE, speed reaching at 4 1/2 knots. Wind turned twice during the night to NE, picked up, then died. Anchored by 9 am in Waterfall Bay - incredibly beautiful spot! There are 2 waterfalls cascading down the cliff side. The local villagers are so happy to see us! Our first stork will go fast here. Saw yelos with Rolf + Dahlia again in Santo, saw Mangwara (the Mongoles) again, met 4 ay & Akpid on Moon Perry.

Mon Sept 18 2003

Had a great time at the festival in Waterfall Bay. The winds were light while we were there, the weather hot + sunny, 15 boats pulled up. Yelo came, we spent a lot of time with them. Met Ophelia, Thomas, Eva and little Lela. Thomas took lots of great pictures. Jimmy, a local, invited us to a meal at his house - sweet potato laplap, bread was surprisingly good, fresh potatoes prawns cooked with green onions, and cassava. They build beautiful huts from palm and bamboo with different designs, palm thatel roofs, little windows instead with pieces of bamboo. Very airy and comfortable! On the beach they put coral rubble to keep the sand down. Jimmy had a house made of bamboo and benches, woven mats on the floor. His entire family sat on the floor and watched us while we ate. The festival was a lot of fun, very intimate with only a few locals. House was inaugurated as the first blood chief in 90 years. He killed a pig - quite humorously by poisoning it with an arrow. He then beating it to death. All the members of his extended family like arrived with pig head on the temple. Lots of dancing and singing. The men + women all wore grass skirts. The snake dancers with the men painted to look like black + white coral snakes with cool. The 2nd day they prepared a traditional feast using all methods, wrapping coconut with clam shells, cooking prawns and fish in pieces of hollow bamboo on hot stones. They ground fresh fish roe with a piece of coral. Their house was made from plastic fishing floats - not exactly traditional! The feast day was held to the top of the waterfall and heard the women making water music with their hands and arms. None of the women could do it! All were all very interesting but we were exhausted from being on shore all day. Sailed to the reef at low tide today.

Fri Sept 26

We left the Reef Islands with regret, where tried of the constant wind blowing 25 knots. It was beautiful here, white powdery sand beach on the island, crystal clear water. Unfortunately the anchorage was exposed, behind the reef, and the island was a half-mile dingy ride away. Had a great time wind surfing. Burema had a great time surfing. Good. Naminda was there, boys were kite surfing. Mangwana came in and the hanging out with the other cruisers, enjoying the beach, getting out of the strong wind. Fast windy passage down to Waterfall Bay today, full up on water, got some fresh fruit.

Sat Sept 27

Too much politeness in Waterfall Bay, the chiefs are arguing with each other but we did get bananas, papayas, grapefruit and plums from both of them. Had dinner with Kerey last night. It is very windy today, we are hard on it, bashing down to Gona, no fun at all! But Char-lotte is doing great, going high to windward, 5 knots average in 25 knots of wind. Four other boats leading to the same anchorage.

Mon Sept 29

Much more pleasant sailing today! The village at Gona was very poor, but I did score a nice carving there. We took an extremely strenuous hike to the lake in the middle of the island with Naminda, 7 hours of hiking total. We barely made it back, the boys got us some coconuts that rejuvenated us. We were the big attraction in the village. The hike through the jungle was interesting, no birds, no wild life, lots of vines to trip over,

We passed steaming mud pools. The lake itself was quite hot along the edges and the water was shallow and warm. The road for an hour on the hot stones along the shoreline and enjoyed the solitude. The walk back was a nightmare, everyone was sore; got a cool shower from the village today there are 30 other boats out here, Naminda, Aldebaran and Elight. Time, all going to Santo. The winds are much lighter, we are clear sailing, quite pleasant for a change.

Thurs Oct 2

Really enjoyed Port Ory. The island we anchored behind was deserted, with a fresh water lake for swimming and laundry. It was pretty with peaceful trees. Good swimming, nice beach. Had dinner on the shore and invited them over for a meal. Today we are going to Peterson Bay, met Naminda, Pacific Blues (another cat like, yellow with greenish & brown aboard) and Fidelis. Caught a huge mahi-mahi we shared with our friends in return for cold beer - good lunch! Nice anchorage behind the reef here.

Fri Oct 3

Decided to run to Luganville this afternoon, hit the stores and the mail tomorrow morning for supplies. Had a nice sail around the island and all the way to the anchorage. Lots of boats in Luganville.

Sat Oct 5

Wanted to head over to Ambae this morning but the post office was closed, but the wind was nonexistent. Quitted we stopped at Aldebaran at 11. Elion Pardon Point and had a great anchor. The US dropped a lot of their left over stuff in the ocean here. We then leave it to the islanders. There were numerous ships,

pieces of kelp, a fork lift, all covered with coral. It was a fun drive. Then we continued around the corner and anchored in Pal: kelo Bay. Time wise was there, we enjoyed a potluck dinner together.

Mon Oct 6

Boisterous sail to Am Gae today! We are out here with 3 other boats. Charlotte is keeping up in speed and pointing to windward. It is an awful rough slog, gusts to 30 knots, burying the bow to the mast at times, way overpowered with the reefed genoa. But we make it, averaging 5 knots! The anchorage at Lo lowai is quite surrounded on 3 sides by rock cliffs, with a narrow shallow entrance. We meet Explorer here with Bob & Hella, hadn't seen them since the Galapagos. Tevaki now is here with their 8-year-old girl, Brian is not thrilled unfortunately.

Sat Oct 11

Joined the festival - it was a 20-minute truck ride up into hills in a big grassy meadow surrounded by huge fan palm and mango trees. The dancing was very colorful and quite powerful at times. The dancers here wear colored mats - a diaper for the men & wraps for the women - skirt + loincloth. Lots of chiefs dressed in full regalia, dancing to show their approval of the presentations. 15 or more boats here, including Tranquility with Rick & Mary, Silverpen with Carl & Kathleen, others. It is a good time. It's nice to get away from the ocean and hang out in a cool green spot all day. We pick up some really different baskets, a chief staff for Brian with a spear point tip.

We liked the peace and enclosedness of the anchorage and the anchorage! Gotter, but decided to move over to Mauss today. 5 miles in an anchorage that I heard was nice. Easy, sail for a change! Just that's because it's so early in the morning, before the trade picks up. We are at Naboro or something like that and the barrels are listening to local reggae music at 9 am!

11th Oct 14

Had a great time in Naboro (Naboro - what a tongue twister!) with the Peace Corps worker, Joanne, and his girlfriend Valerie. Michael his XP laptop that was cracked. He took us to the waterfall, along with Kathleen & Carl or Silvan, very hot walk. I did my laundry at the village spring, got to meet the shy but friendly Milapera. We were only. He lost to stop there. At a pleasant interlude. This morning we pushed down to Camwari, where there is a 'ghost club' hosted by Chief Kleson. Really had we come to Mauss!

11th Oct 16

Camwari had a picture-perfect village and a nice view of the channel across to Puntecost, but it was too nice, they are in need to having cruises there. We did trade for some more presents, now we have lots of presents! Took a great anchor down clean water, saw big crocodiles and a family of people. I did my laundry at the waterfall, very convenient! Today we left at 4am, hoping for a good wind to blow us the 11 miles to Longville. On arrival we got barely 10 knots, a slow but pleasant trip, made it in 13 hours, right to the anchorage we are with to Aldebaran again!

Wed Oct 29

Got stuck in Luganville for the weekend - the weather was awful - it blew & rained on Saturday, then rained all Sunday. The Rally hype was intense - all those bawdy people talking themselves into going to sea. Talked to Tranquillity & Silverfish Monday morning - they were in Peterson Bay so we went up there. There we finally met Indulgence II with Mike, Elke and Ben; also Julia with Larry & Kenj and Overproof with Virginia & Derek. We had seen these boats since Fiji!

Brian was happy to hang out with Ben, or Larry from Julia, those guys are big boys! We had a wonderful time there, diving to the Blue Hole, diving the crashed airplane on the reef, partying with the other boats. Just before they were planning to leave for Australia, last Thursday, Ben was jumping off our spreader with Brian, slipped and fell on the life lines, gashed his head on the fairail. He looked pretty beat up at first. Got on atm helance and got him to the hospital. Luckily, he only needed some stitches in his fore head. He was back the next day, feeling fine. So we stayed too, spent a lot of time with Indulgence & Julia.

Finally got out of Peterson Bay on Monday, went down to Palakula Bay. Had a blast exploring the freighter beached there, swimming in the clear water. Hang out with Carl & Kathleen on Silverfish for the day. Gated to leave!

But it is fine to go on now - 2 weeks of light winds ahead and Chesterfield Reef behind. We have 10-12 knots of wind from the SE, we are still sailing along the south coast of Espiritu Santo. Good bye Vanuatu - it has been a memorable 100 months!

Thurs Oct 30

Well it could be worse! Last night was peaceful after we pulled out the genoa, moving at 4 1/2 knots, wind backed to the east. This morning the wind almost died completely, we were lurching along at 1 1/2 knots for a while. Not thrilling, but better than nothing. The wind came back this afternoon, 8 1/2 knots and we are moving smoothly at 5 knots with four sails up. Nice sailing! Well instead of very light winds for this trip, want to get to Chesterfield with only a few calm days here before the last leg back to a point.

34-hour run: 105 miles

Fri Oct 31

Beautiful night last night, changing along up to 6 knots at times with 4 sails up, following the path made by the extremely bright crescent moon. It was quite comfortable - we are all enjoying this sail. Will head to Oudience & Qalia this morning. Last a big fish along with the lure, Thomas is hungry for some thing different. He ate through oysters and coconut shells in Peterson Bay!

34-hour run: 115 miles

Sat Nov 1

Another nice night but some light winds. It was hot, progress slow, but didn't slow well. Finally got a bit more wind late in afternoon. Caught a huge mako just off the sun rise.

34-hour run: 117 miles

Sun Nov 2

Not a very exciting day - been almost becalmed most of it. Trying to get the boat going again now, before sunset. Morale is good, however!

24-hour run - 85 miles. Oh - had some hitchhikers last night! A tired booby landed on the mizzen boom just after sunset. He was no problem - his ass was hanging over the water; but then his feedlines landed on the spreaders and all of a sudden there was bird shit all over the place. Thomas chased them off, but the first one stayed until sunrise.

Mon Nov 3

Today is flat calm, oily sea, totally lazy gray horizon, no visibility. We play with the sails and then get tired of it. Very hot, good day to do laundry!

24-hour run - 56 miles

Tues Nov 4

Wind came back late yesterday afternoon with a bang! Within an hour we had the main aback, mizzen reefed, furled genoa. It blew like sink all night - 30-35 knots. At dawn the south. It was relatively calm north of Chesterfield Reef, which we passed in the middle of the night. No stopping or uncharted reefs in this weather! Finally switched to stay sail to try to slow the boat down. Overproof and Underproof got nailed too, after we. Very uncomfortable ride - good flying - all over the place. Being becalmed sounds good now! Well head to Frederick Reef now and stop there.

24 hour run - 135 miles

Mon Nov. 24

We arrived in Bundaberg Monday morning at sunrise, had to slow down some once we passed the reef. There were 20 boats ahead of us awaiting chicken! Got through by 4 pm, piece of cake. Relaxed with Andulgera II. Bundaberg river entrance was not particularly thrilling - very flat, ugly gray water poisonous sea snakes. We went up river to the town with Virginia on Overproof for a few days, to do some shopping. Bundaberg was neat and clean, everything available. The men walk around in Crocodile Dundee cut jorts and the women are scantily dressed. Very redneck. Spent a couple more days at the mouth of the river until Julie with Ken & Larry showed up. Left Mon the 17th for Fraser Island - what a great spot! It was paradisiacal there - miles of white sandy beaches, crystal clear water, birds. But the wind turned NW and we had to get out. Too bad - it would have been perfect for wind surfing in the lagoon. Spent the next few days traveling south to the Great Sandy Straits. Great sailing in flat water, but the NW winds made anchoring uncomfortable. Finally found some protection in Goy's Anchorage. Came down to Tin Can Bay yesterday - just before the wind turned south again. Anchored in this river here, quite a way from town, but it's peaceful. Lots of sand bars, sleeping little town. Overproof is here, mostly Aussie boats. While he stuck until wind turns NE again. Bundaberg high lights: nasty thick gray sea snakes, 1000's of bats flying across the river at sunset. Chucky water!

Mon Dec 8 2003

Enjoyed our week in Tin Cay Bay - we met Virginia on Overproof here and she arranged a trip to a National Forest and a hike to Lake Boona with some friends of hers. It was beautiful - large old Kauri trees towering out of sight, thousands of birds. A had a refreshing swim in the fresh water lake. Tin Cay Bay was very quiet, but people were friendly, and I turned at the library was free. The dinghy ride was a 1/2 hr long and wet. Mostly only Australian boats around. We spent one day at Onokup Point, and walked part of the endless windward beach. Today we left at 4:30 to sail down to Mooololaba, 60 miles. I had a lot of wind in the morning, but it picked up to 15 in the afternoon. The bar ceasing to offshore was very - 20 boats went to sea after, motoring through 6 ft swells, trying to push out. What a 300! But of course eventually they all passed Charlotte. We got in and were anchored by 4, found a nice hole to sit in. Very suburban here - fancy huge hillsidey houses along the waterfront.

Mon Jan 5 2004

A month went by quickly in Mooololaba! A guess we were comfortable there. Of took a while to get used to the scene, but we enjoyed afternoon on the beach, with Brian on his boogie board. He really got into it! Saleita with Martin, Katherine and 8-yr-old child, showed up, so we decided to spend Christmas with them. It was a fun day, spent time on the beach as usual. Brian drove away wanting things. got into afternoon quiet morning sunning walking out at an exercise site. Silvest. Kinner came through it just days before Christmas, also tranquility. We went to

the Australia Zoo and saw crocodiles, kangaroos, and koalas, also many snakes, poisonous & pythons. We saw the last Lord of the Rings movie. Got used to the gypsie - tourist atmosphere but then the water cops came around and begged us to move on. Andelence & Julia arrived, but they were disappointing - too involved in each other. It was a fun month, but then the move on. Today winds are light and we took all day to get 40 miles south to Tangalooma, on Moreton Island. We saw Desert Rosa sailing north to Mosoolaba - what a shame to miss them by a day.

Tues Jan 6

After a morning of school work, we decided to move on as the anchorage was getting rally. Today is great sailing - downwind with the breeze peaked out. Only 20 miles to Red Island where we will wait out the NW flow. We meet up with Virginia on Overproof here - lots of boats, but it is a big bay, long sandy beach. Thomas is trying windsurfing here 7.5 - new year. Even in Mosoolaba was fantastic - lots of fireworks on the beach, some in a boat out on the water. It was a sight with the lights on the crashing surf, fireworks shooting into the waves. The Australians worked very hard at getting drunk, what a scene.

March 24

Lots of catching up to do! We arrived at the Spit in Southport on Sun Jan 11, after a fun weekend at Dex anchorage, on northern South Island where we met members of the Southport Yacht Club. Saw lots of wall abas there, beautiful. Keel with perfect sand dunes. We were appalled when we first

improved the hook in Southport, high rise building dotting the skyline.
Just the Sp. was very pretty, with the beach right next to the
front and the ocean not far away. And there were kid boats!
The really enjoyed Mowbray, a local boat boat with Shawn, George
and local kids. Ray, and Nicki. Brian became special
friends with all 3 of them. Silas, Sam, Canadian with Ray,
Nadia, boys Bradley & Henry, stayed for a month. Brian and
Bradley became pretty good friends and made up a game to play.
Now there were the Canada boats. La Passante with Les,
Alber, Gordon & Amy. Keenan III with Bruce, Robert, Jackson &
Ryan, 2 big goofy boys. Hot Brian had a lot of fun with them.
Nadia had friends on the beach at night and had a life of their
own. A enjoyed visiting Brian in town - he has good people
around. Thomas had a lot of wind surfing - figured out water
sports and likes in the flat water behind the sand bar.
Also enjoyed friend ship, happy hours on the beach, lots of
swimming & beach walks. Found a small python, called a carpet
snake, on the path down to the beach - he would come out at
evening, just before sundown. Rick & Mary on Tranquility
beach in and stayed. It was hard to leave - we felt part of
the community for a change. After much agonizing about what
to do with our lives, we decided to sail directly back to the
US unless plans change of course! So it is time to move on
and we are on our way back to Moo La La, to take care of
all the things, no vision, and then on the Great Barrier Reef.
We have enjoyed the fantastic weather and and surf of
Australia, and around English sounds normal to us now!